

CHUK310115B

Coda consonant clusters. Duhumbi appears to share with Dirang Tshangla (Bodt 2012:) and Bjoka Tshangla (Grollmann 2014:) a limited number of occurrences of preserved syllable-final consonant clusters. Standard Bhutan Tshangla also has vestiges of these coda clusters (Bodt 2012:). The coda clusters all involve a syllable-final nasal or trill followed by a consistently unreleased stop. These clusters might be relevant from a historical-comparative point of view, but their extremely restricted occurrence and problematic audibility makes it hard to come to any strong conclusions. Nonetheless, a number of rather convincing minimal pairs is presented here, of which audio recordings exist for future reference.

hampta ‘read, study’ vs. hamda ‘smell’, e.g. jige oḏzop le hampma ‘study hard’ vs. ɕis hamma ‘smell the smell’. hampma vs hamma

lampta ‘fry’ vs. lamda ‘search’, e.g. koŋpu lampta ‘fry finger millet’ vs. sojnam lamda ‘beg for alms’

rampta ‘wither’ vs. ramda ‘harvest’, e.g. niɕi gaŋpu ramplon ‘the paddy has all withered’ vs. walo? niɕi gaŋgpu ramlonbej ‘they have harvested all the paddy’.

zaŋʔta ‘construct (H); get up (H)’ vs. zaŋ ‘Jang (in Tawang)’, e.g. wojo? gonpa hin zaŋʔlon ‘he has constructed a monastery’ and rinpoṭɕ^he namsaŋ duktse zaŋʔlon ‘rinpoche has woken up early in the morning’.

ŋarʔta ‘win’ vs. ŋarma ‘tough, strong’, e.g. naŋŋo? wojni ŋarʔma/ŋartma aj ‘you win from him ok’ vs. woj budun ŋarma bi? ‘he is a tough person’

There are two example without minimal pair: budun dɪŋdɪŋ ‘a healthy person’_ dɪŋʔta ‘pull along thread’, e.g. dejju hwaŋ dɪŋʔni ‘yesterday the thread got pulled along’ hwaŋ dɪŋʔta jokkor tutonlon ‘pulling the thread along the spindle had fallen down’ and timpta ‘become finished’ vs. cf. CHUK110614H_0014; Tsangpa Dorji Choijom 30012015. And there are two doubt cases: ṭɕampta ‘surrender’ vs. ṭɕamda ‘be comfortable’, e.g. ɕoj nisk^ho hin ṭɕampni ‘from two

bulls one surrendered’ vs. naŋ deju gari naŋk^ho t̪ɕamɲiɲi? ‘where you comfortable in the car yesterday’ and *d̪ʒaŋʔta ‘study’ vs. d̪ʒaŋda ‘fall’, e.g. woj jige od̪zop d̪ʒaŋʔti? ‘he studies well’ vs. woj pha? t^hupda d̪ʒaŋdi? ‘he falls in drunkenness’.

Some additional examples, of which no individual recordings exist, include

go? deju budun ɲis ziɲɲi_yesterday I took along two people_ *ziɲʔda ‘take along’ vs. ziɲ ‘internode’ cf. [CHUK221212D2_0039] t̪ɕ^ha-ziɲʔ-ma ‘take them along to eat’ vs. mejd̪zu ziɲ ‘internode of sugarcane’.
t^himpta ‘sink’ vs. t̪^himda ‘convict’ cf. t^himp-ɲi ‘sunk’
norta ‘err’ vs. nor ‘cattle’ cf. nort-ɲi ‘erred’

Two observations regarding these clusters:

The clusters seem restricted to a bilabial nasal + bilabial stop /-mp/ (three confirmed, two doubt); a velar nasal + velar stop /-ŋk/ (two confirmed, two doubt) and trill + alveolar stop /-rt/ (one confirmed, one doubt). Conspicuous absentee here is the combination of alveolar nasal + alveolar stop /-nt/ which was earlier reported for Tshangla (Bodt 2012:).

All the verbs with syllable-final consonant clusters fall in the Ta-class, suggesting (cf. section XXX) that they had an additional syllable-final /s/ at the proto-level, something which is additionally confirmed by the Written Tibetan cognates for some of the verbs, e.g.

Perhaps this is additional evidence not for coda-clusters but for pre-nasalised stops in the proto-language even in onset position? E.g. ^ɲg > ŋa and ga > ka ‘1SG’; ^mbiɲ > miɲ and biɲ ‘name’; ⁿd > ?

çoj nis tsompak^ho, hin tçampa bi?_when two bulls fight one surrenders_
tçamptçupni_were surrendering_

pema tç^haba tç^haɲini? tç^hama inda jokçima datpa leda. batç^habale_jokçima
jokçima_did pema eat serve and give taking care_
tçampni_surrendered_

çoj nisk^ho hin tçampni_from two bulls one surrendered_
t^hon ljaŋka_flat bridge